



GOOD THINGS HAPPEN

Newsletter of Minnehaha United Methodist Church

We seek, we serve, we celebrate.

DEC 2017

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December

Good Things Happen
is the newsletter of
Minnehaha United Methodist Church
published each month.

The deadline for January is
December 15

Contributions may be brought to the office
or emailed to:
office@minnehaha.org

Minneapolis, MN 55417

About Us:

Minnehaha United Methodist Church is a thriving multi-generational, multicultural Christian community devoted to social justice and personal spiritual growth. The congregation is both mission- and worship-focused. In addition to its worship, education, and social activities, the church supports local mission activities, including a food shelf and a monthly food distribution program. The church also supports a variety of national and international relief, education, and development projects.

A Reconciling Congregation:

Minnehaha United Methodist Church opens our doors to all God's people. We will strive to offer unconditional love and acceptance to all persons, regardless of race, sexual orientation or faith history. We work to eliminate prejudice and discriminatory practices within ourselves and within our community. -adopted 2006

Our Mission:

We seek, we serve, we celebrate, we carry our Christian faith into our community and the world. We provide a caring gathering place to worship God and to grow spiritually. -reconfirmed 2011

SUNDAY WORSHIP -SUMMER SCHEDULE

9:00 am Worship with organ and choir.

10:00am Education and Fellowship.

11:00 am Worship with band and vocals.

Infant and toddler care available all morning.

Minnehaha Happenings in December

Sun	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat
					1 <i>World AIDS Day</i> 9a Brighter Minds 10a Al-Anon 6:30p NAMI 6:30p NAMI (additional) 6:30p RCA	2 9a UMW Cookie Baking 9:30a Advent Festival 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 6p Scouts - Crew 1
3 <i>Advent begins</i> Communion 9a Worship with Organ 10a Education & Fellowship 11a Worship with Band 4p Youth & Conf. Classes 6:30p Togo Church 7p SAA	4 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 2:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Boy Scouts - Troop 1 6:30p Cub Scouts 6:30p Finance	5 9a Fun & Fit. 10:30a Food Shelf 10:30a Toys 1:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Toastmasters	6 10a Staff Meeting 1p Minnehaha circle 5p Methodicals 6:45p Chancel Choir 7p Children's Council	7 9a Food Shelf Board 9a Fun & Fit. 9a Minnehaha Playgroup 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 10a What's a Prophet? 2:30p Brighter Minds Music	8 9a Brighter Minds 10a Al-Anon 6:30p NAMI 6:30p RCA 7p Blue Christmas Taizé 8p NAMI	9 9:30a Brighter Minds Music
10 <i>Human Rights Day</i> 9a Worship with Organ 10a Education & Fellowship 11a Worship with Band 2p Youth Council 4p Living Brave 4p Youth Group 7p SAA	11 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 2:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Boy Scouts - Troop 1	12 9a Fun & Fit. 10:30a Food Shelf 10:30a Toys 1:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Church Council	13 5p Methodicals 5:30p Pageant Rehearsal & Dinner 6:45p Chancel Choir	14 9a Fun & Fit. 9a Minnehaha Playgroup 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 10a What's a Prophet? 1p Communion @ Nokomis Sq 2:30p Brighter Minds Music	15 <i>Newsletter items due</i> 9a Brighter Minds 10a Al-Anon 6:30p NAMI 6:30p RCA	16 7a Minne-Harvest 9:30a Brighter Minds Music
17 9a Worship with Organ 10a Education & Fellowship 11a Worship with Band 4p Christmas Pageant and Dinner 6:30p Togo Church 7p SAA	18 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 2:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Boy Scouts - Troop 1 6:30p Cub Scouts 6:30p Women's Soul Group	19 9a Fun & Fit. 10:30a Food Shelf 10:30a Toys 1:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Toastmasters	20 5p Methodicals 6:45p Chancel Choir	21 <i>Winter Solstice</i> 9a Fun & Fit. 9a Minnehaha Playgroup 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 10a What's a Prophet? 2:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Trustees & B+G	22 9a Brighter Minds 9a Newsletter Collation 10a Al-Anon 6:30p NAMI 6:30p RCA	23 9:30a Brighter Minds Music
24 10a Worship 4p Christmas Eve Worship (with band & flashlights) 7p SAA 10p Christmas Eve Worship with Choir and Candlelight	25 <i>Christmas</i> 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 2:30p Brighter Minds Music	26 9a Fun & Fit. 10:30a Food Shelf 1:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p SPR	27 5p Methodicals 6:45p Chancel Choir	28 9a Fun & Fit. 9a Minnehaha Playgroup 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 10a What's a Prophet? 2:30p Brighter Minds Music	29 9a Brighter Minds 10a Al-Anon 6:30p NAMI 6:30p RCA	30 9:30a Brighter Minds Music
31 10a Worship 6:30p Togo Church 7p SAA	Notes: The calendar is accurate, to the best of our knowledge, at the time of printing. Dates and details may change at any time. Please visit www.minnehaha.org to view an up-to-date version of the calendar, and please contact Heather before scheduling any meetings or events. If they aren't on the calendar, you are not guaranteed a meeting space.					

Worship in December

We get the shortest celebration of Advent this year. Advent is the time of preparation for Christmas. Unlike Lent, Advent is counted by Sundays and not by actual days, and so the number of days in Advent varies from year to year, depending on where in the week Christmas falls. Last year, with Christmas on a Sunday, we had the longest possible Advent, a full four weeks. But this year, since Christmas falls on a Monday, December 24 serves both as the Fourth Sunday of Advent (in the morning) and as Christmas Eve (in the evening). So our fourth week of Advent is really only about ¾ of a day. We will celebrate both the Fourth Sunday of Advent and Christmas Eve, so note that there will be one service (celebrating Advent) in the morning at 10:00am and then our usual Christmas Eve services at 4:00pm and 10:00pm. It is traditional to hold off on the singing of Christmas Carols until Christmas Eve, and then we are invited to sing them with abandon throughout the 12 days of Christmas until Epiphany (on January 6). While I don't really expect you to hold off humming Away in a Manger or Hark the Herald Angels Sing while you are sitting at home or out running errands, we will do our best to refrain from that in worship. There are some lovely Advent songs in our hymnal, and we'll be singing many of them in the month of December. We also have an Advent Devotional prepared by Herb Ferrer to accompany our Advent journey this month, so be sure and pick up your copy at church (or call and ask us to mail one to you).

Please also note that there will be only one service at 10:00am on Sunday, December 31. We'll be celebrating the passing of time, and another year, in the worship service.

3rd	"Smoothing the Road"	Isaiah 40:1-5
	<i>1st Sunday of Advent, Communion</i>	
10th	"Flowers Along the Road"	Isaiah 40:6-11
17th	"A Journey With Justice"	Isaiah 61:1-4, 8-11
24th	10:00 am "Journeying with God"	Luke 1:26-38
	4:00 pm Child –friendly Christmas Eve Service	
	10:00 pm Traditional Christmas Eve Service with Candlelight	
31st	"Time"	Luke 2:22-40

Save the Date

Future special events at Minnehaha UMC:

Jan. 4 – Thursday morning World Religions class begins
 Jan. 8 – Monday evenings What Do United Methodists Believe? class begins
 Jan. 10 – Food Shelf Pasta Dinner
 Jan. 21 – Annual Meeting
 Jan. 26-28 – Winter Retreat
 Feb. 10-11 – Annual musical *Rockin' Snow White*
 Feb. 14 – Ash Wednesday (Lent begins)
 March 3 – Auction
 March 11 – Daylight Savings begins (spring ahead)
 March 24 – First annual Talent Show and Dessert Auction
 March 29 – Maundy Thursday
 March 30 – Good Friday
 April 1 – Easter Sunday

RELIEVE EDITORIAL STRESS:

**TURN IN
YOUR ARTICLES
EARLY!**

R E M I N D E R :

**DEADLINE FOR
NEWSLETTER
ARTICLES IS**

December 15

Youth Ministries

December Events

Dec. 2nd Advent Kick-off! Join the Youth and the rest of the Church as we get our building ready for Advent. We will be walking to Nokomis Beach Coffee to purchase a Christmas tree and caroling on the way back, youth will also be pulling the artificial trees out of the attic at church and setting them up in the Narthex. There will be donuts and hot cocoa, cookie baking and so much more. Join us from 9:30-11:30am.

Dec. 3rd Confirmation Class: Classes are from 4:00-5:30pm. Grades 6th-7th are with Lani in the 3rd floor Youth Room discussing *Gifts and Presence*, and 8th-9th Graders are with Becky in the 3rd floor Choir Room talking about *Stories of Jesus Death and Resurrection*.

Dec. 10th Youth Night - Snack Crate Video and Cardboard Fort Night. For grades 6th-12th from 4-6pm, Youth will be trying Snack crates from around the world and making reaction videos of them for their YouTube Channel.

When the Youth are off camera, they will be working together to build the coolest Cardboard fort possible in the time allowed.

Dec. 13th

- **Christmas Pageant rehearsal:** All Church dinner is at 5:30pm, Rehearsal at 6:15pm in Sunday School rooms.
- **Orchestra Rehearsal:** 7pm with Jenny Ammerman. Bring a music stand if you have one.

Dec. 17th

- **Orchestra Rehearsal:** 3pm with Jenny Ammerman. Bring a music stand if you have one.
- **Christmas Pageant:** Starts at 4:00pm
No evening Confirmation classes

Dec. 24th Christmas Eve:

No evening Confirmation classes

Dec. 31st New Years Eve:

No evening Confirmation classes

Thank you!

Leilani Thompson, *Director of Youth Ministries*



Minnehaha Playgroup

For Children 5 and Under & their Caregivers

Thursdays, from 9-11am

Stop in to play, talk, explore, support, and learn together. Feel free to bring snacks (no peanuts, please) if your child will need them. No RSVP necessary. All are welcome.

hosted by

Minnehaha United Methodist Church

When weather permits, we gather at local parks for playgroup. Otherwise, we meet at Minnehaha UMC, in the Childcare Room. If you'd like to join us on any given week, and want to know where to find us: join the "Minnehaha Playgroup" Facebook Page for weekly updates.

Children's Ministries

Happy Advent from Minnehaha Children's Ministries!

On December 3rd, we'll begin the Advent season. Advent is the time when we prepare for Christmas, for the arrival of Jesus into the world. We know (literally and figuratively) the darkness that's around us, we know longing for peace, we know stress from trying to prepare. As we journey through Advent this year, we invite families to contemplate how God is beside us through our journey, even in the darkness. We invite families to connect with one another on this journey - working together to bring justice and light to the world. We invite families to celebrate that God comes to us, and in that there is cause for much joy. There is hope.

We'll be preparing for the journey together as a community on Saturday, December 2nd.

★ We invite you for a morning of fellowship and of preparing our spaces for the Advent season. Christmas trees will go up, paper chains and stars created, murals drawn, carols sung, hot chocolate and donuts consumed. There is also an opportunity to join in the cookie exchange. Hosted each year by the Minnehaha United Methodist Women, people are encouraged to come with cookies (either already made or ready to bake in the Minnehaha ovens) and at the end of the morning, we'll exchange cookies and prepare cookie platters for the people in our congregation who are shut-in's. This Advent Festival is from 9:30-11:30am.

Another exciting part of Advent at Minnehaha is our preparation for the Christmas Pageant. Preparations have begun, and will continue in earnest through the next few weeks. Please have your child(ren) and youth at Sunday School as regularly as possible so they can be preparing their parts.

On Wednesday, 13th December we will have a run-through of the pageant:

★ Join us for dinner first at 5:30pm, and then the run-through will begin at 6pm, and our goal will be to have everyone done by 6:45.

★ The pageant is on Sunday, 17th December at 4pm, and will be followed by an all-church dinner.

If you will be around to worship with us for Christmas Eve - which happens to be a Sunday this year! - we will have one service in the morning at 10am (no Sunday School) observing the fourth Sunday of Advent. Then, we'll celebrate Christmas Eve with two evening services, at 4pm and 10pm.

And, finally - it's not too early to begin planning for 2018:

★ On Saturday, 6th January: Children's Council is hosting a Child Care Night and Parents' Night Out. Child care will be provided at the church from 5-8pm; and parents are invited to join together for dinner. Details will follow soon - but please mark your calendars and plan on joining us!

★ The Winter Retreat will be from Friday, 26th January - Sunday, 28th January at Lake Koronis Assembly Grounds in Paynesville. This year's theme is "Fill My Cup." Registration forms are available in the narthex, or online at <https://www.jotform.com/Minnehaha/minnehaha-winter-retreat-2018>.

As always, please let me know if you have any questions or concerns.

May your journey towards Christmas bring you peace and joy.

"The light shines in the darkness, and the darkness did not overcome it." John 1:5

Jenia Strom

Director of Children & Family Ministries

Highlights from the November 14 Church Council Meeting

PASTOR'S 2018 COMPENSATION PACKAGE

APPROVED: A Charge Conference was held at the start of the Council meeting to approve Becky's compensation package—salary, pension, health insurance, continuing education, travel and other professional expenses—for 2018. The amount presented by the Staff-Parish Relations committee is: \$97,820.56. It was approved unanimously. (Stuart Hazard, *Staff-Parish Relations*)

TREASURER'S REPORT: We are current with all bills, mortgage payments, apportionment payments and inter-fund loan payments through October 31, 2017. The mortgage debt for our 2010 building project is now below \$350,000. (Hooray!) And according to our Treasurer, "We are in a good position with our budget heading into 2018." (Dennis Feller, *Treasurer*)

STEWARDSHIP DRIVE STARTED NOV. 12:

Minnehaha UMC's annual stewardship campaign began on Sunday, November 12. The theme is: A Healthy Church. As the campaign letter says, "We are a healthy church, filled with current ministries and endless possibilities." Remember to fill out and turn in your pledge card. (Becky Sechrist, *Pastor*)



Halloween party

NEW BABY CHANGING STATIONS: Two new changing stations were installed this past week. One is in the Men's Room on the second floor and the other is in the unisex bathroom on the lower level. Thank you, Chad Mayer! (Kim Kanuit, *Trustees*)

SIMPSON SHELTER ON DECEMBER 28: Minnehaha will serve at Simpson Shelter on December 28. If you're able to help prep the meal or serve, contact Maureen Trepp. (Maureen Trepp, *United Methodist Women*)

FAMILIES MOVING FORWARD ON APRIL 3: We have been asked to help with a special mission at Lake Nokomis Lutheran Church on April 3. The church hosts

a program called Families Moving Forward that gives homeless or families in transition a place to stay for a week. Minnehaha UMC has taken on the date of April 3 to serve there. There will also be training on Saturday, January 13, at Lake Nokomis Lutheran Church. If you're interested, contact Maureen Trepp at 612-724-7620 or maureen-trepp@yahoo.com. (Maureen Trepp, *United Methodist Women*)



UMW Bazaar

FEED THE HUNGRY: The Minnehaha Food Shelf is in need of donations to feed the 500-plus adults, seniors and children in the neighborhood who are food insecure. We encourage you to bring non-perishable food or write a check to the church and indicate that it's for the Food Shelf. Thank you! (Judy Durfey, *Food Shelf*)

FOOD SHELF PASTA DINNER ON JAN. 10: Mark your calendars for January 10 from 5:00 – 7:00 p.m. for the annual Pasta Dinner to support the Minnehaha Food Shelf. Food will once again be provided by Fat Lorenzo's, and the popular Accordion Band will return to play for the event. (Judy Durfey, *Food Shelf*)



UMW Bazaar

Christmas Eve

Please join us, and invite your friends and neighbors, for Christmas Eve services this year. We'll have a more child-oriented service (which adults are welcome to attend as well.) at 4:00pm featuring music with The Methodicals and a more traditional candlelight service with choir and organ at 10:00pm.

Adult Classes Sneak Preview

World Religions

A new 6-week class will begin on Thursday, January 4 from 10-11:30 am. Utilizing a video series, we'll learn about the major religions of the world – Hinduism, Buddhism, Judaism, and Islam, as well as learn a bit more about the differences in Christianity between Protestants, Catholics, and Orthodox. There is no need to prepare anything beforehand, just come to class, watch the video, and engage in conversation.

What Do United Methodists Believe?

Although theology in the United Methodist Church is not a rigid thing, there are particular beliefs that define who we are. If you'd like to find out more about what United Methodists believe about concepts like heaven, hell, grace, baptism, etc., come on Monday evenings from 6:30-7:30pm. The class starts on January 8 and runs through Feb. 12. Depending on the size of the class and other uses of the building, we'll either be in the chapel on the main floor or up in room 310. Look for a sign at the front entrance letting you know what room we'll be in each evening.

Give a Little Gift

It's November and this is a reminder that the Walker Methodist Health Center asks again for support of unwrapped gifts for the residents who live there. Their population is about 240 people, plus or minus a few. Each person gets a special bag of gifts each year because of the kindness and generosity of people of the Methodist and other churches. I have posted posters in two places at church with lists of suggestions. They like socks, slippers, scarves, caps, little Christmas decorations that can delight them. They also like candy and cracker treats, as well as personal items like combs, brushes, etc. I will have a box with the title "Give a Little Gift: Please leave your contributions there or call me, Wanda Driver, 612/729-4210, and I will pick your donation up. I have voice mail so you can leave a message, if I can't answer.

One-Service Sundays

Both Christmas Eve and New Year's Eve fall on Sundays this year, and we'll be having one worship service at 10:00am on both days. We will also be having our usual Christmas Eve services later on December 24, at 4:00pm and 10:00pm, but the morning will only have one service at 10:00am with a celebration of the Fourth Sunday of Advent.

It's time for Advent.

Time to: Prepare. Focus. Hope. Love. Joy. Wonder. Breath.

It's time to prepare for the journey towards Christmas.

It's time to share the story & to share the light.



Join us as we begin the Advent season with an

Advent Wreath Making Party **EVERYONE is INVITED**

Minnehaha United Methodist Church
Sunday, November 26th
10am in the Fellowship Hall
Cost for each wreath: \$8

Food Shelf

★ In December, as we prepare for Christmas, the River-view Theater again will be showing the traditional holiday movies. Food Shelf volunteers will deliver the blue barrels to the theater and have volunteers on hand to gather food donations by those patrons coming alone, with friends or with families. This is such a great deal for patrons and for the Food Shelf. Ticket prices are reduced, food and money are donated to the Minnehaha Food Shelf, and all who attend enjoy seeing these movies over and over again. (Note: George Gallagher has talked with the manager and has been told the dates will likely be Thursday, Dec. 21, Friday, Dec. 22, and Saturday, Dec. 23). Watch for details of the movie times as they are confirmed.

★ The Pasta Dinner on Wednesday, January 10, 5-7 p. m. is the annual and major fundraiser for the Minnehaha Food Shelf. Already, volunteers are soliciting for door prizes; tickets are available for advanced purchase; and the pasta will again be prepared by Fat Lorenzo's. And, of course, "The Accordion Band is ready to play!" Mark the date on your calendars now and cross your fingers we do not have a snow storm that night. (*See poster right*)

Food Shelf Fundraiser



Pasta Dinner

donated by Fat Lorenzo's

Plus Door Prizes, Accordion Band & More!

Wednesday, January 10th
5:00 – 7:00 PM

Adults: \$10 | Ages 12 & Under: Free

MINNEHAHA UNITED METHODIST CHURCH
3701 East 50th St., Mpls • www.minnehaha.org/foodshelf.html



Minnehaha UMC Mitten & Winter Gear Drive

Throughout the month of December, please consider bringing mittens, hats, scarves, and other winter gear to Minnehaha. We'll put it on our mitten tree (in the narthex), and then gift them to clients of the Minnehaha Food Shelf.

Thank you for your generosity!

Toy Drive

One of the ways we serve at Minnehaha is through the Food Shelf toy drive.

During the last Tuesday of November and the first 3 Tuesdays of December Food Self Parents are able to select toys for their children ranging from baby toys to dolls to remote controlled cars to table foosball and clock radios for older children. All batteries are provided. Each child received a new toy, a stocking stuffer and a hat and or gloves if needed. We also had gift bags and wrapping paper. All this is made possible by the generosity of members of Minnehaha.

There are three ways to help with this mission

- ★ Buy toys and bring them to church
- ★ Designate an offering for toys in the Sunday offering
- ★ Donate cash to be used for toys

Feeling a Little Blue for Christmas

Sure, there's lots to be joyful about as we approach Christmas, but the shorter days and colder temperatures don't leave everyone full of good cheer. Add in a feeling of frenzy from the rush of the season, and it already begins to feel a little overwhelming. Add in even more, a job loss or change, the loss of a loved one, a change in health, a strained friendship, a move, and it can begin to feel like we are out of sync with the joy being expressed at every turn.

You are invited to rest awhile in silence, in quiet music, and in the glow of candlelight as we observe our Blue Christmas Taizé service on December 8 at 7:00 p.m. Whether you need an opportunity to just sit still for a little bit, or you are looking for a way to acknowledge feelings of loss or depression, join with others for an hour of reflection and rest as we continue to find God's presence in the midst of wherever we are.

Communion at Nokomis Square

On the second Thursday of the month at 1:00 p.m., there is a brief communion service at Nokomis Square preceded by a discussion of some kind around current events in the world or in the church. In December we will be gathering on December 14.

CHRISTMAS POINSETTIAS

It is Minnehaha tradition to decorate our sanctuary with poinsettias for the week of Christmas. If you would like to be part of this, complete the order form below and bring it to the church office (or drop it in an offering basket). The cost is \$14 per poinsettia (6.5" pot single red poinsettia). You may take your plant home after the 10pm Christmas Eve Service.

Orders should be turned in by December 9 at noon.

Name: _____

Phone: _____

Please dedicate this plant in: (select one) Honor Celebration Memory Other
of: _____



ORDER YOUR
POINSETTIAS

UMW to Serve at Simpson Shelter

We will begin serving dinner again at Simpson Shelter on Dec. 28 and always welcome new folks who would like to help with this local mission. We need folks to prepare the main dish either the day or evening before and servers to meet at Simpson or at church at 5:45 to carpool. We are done serving around 8:00. We also have been asked to help with a special mission at Lake Nokomis Lutheran Church on April 3. They host a program called Families Moving Forward that gives homeless or families in transition a place to stay for a week and we have taken on that date to serve there. There is a training involved for a couple people but others can come and help with the evening meal and program. Hopefully we will have enough people interested to help during July when they host the program again. If you are interested in either mission, Simpson or Families moving Forward, please contact Maureen Trepp at 612-724-7620 or maureen-trepp@yahoo.com.

Church Musical

Calling all actors, singers, costume makers, stage managers: our annual all ages, all church musical will begin rehearsal the first week in January for 3 performances of "Rockin' Snow White" on Feb. 10 and 11. Be a part of this production! Please let Maureen Trepp (612-724-7620) know if you or your children are interested in participating. Evening rehearsals except Wed., Fri. and Sat..

Save the Date: Auction March 3, 2018

"Auction is coming!! Watch for more information and start collecting treasures for March auction. Details and the January newsletter."



*As we start off a 2018 – fresh out of the holiday season -
let's be sure to make time amidst the craziness for time together,
for fun, for calm, for sanity's sake...*

the Minnehaha Children's Council's **Winter Child Care at Minnehaha & Parents' Night Out**

When: Saturday, 6th January from 5-8pm
Where: Child Care Provided at Minnehaha UMC

Cost:

\$25-1 child

\$35-2 children

\$40-3 children

For children up to 10 years of age
proceeds support the children & youth programs

PLEASE RSVP BY December 30th
Online Registration Available – Link at
www.minnehaha.org
or by calling Jenia at 612.721.6231

(Continued from page 6)

TOYS AND MORE FOR FOOD SHELF FAMILIES:

You can help make sure every child and teen whose family uses our Food Shelf has a present this Christmas. Renee Beymer is collecting toys and other gifts that parents and guardians can select for their children when visiting the Food Shelf. Your generosity is appreciated. (Renee Beymer, *Christmas Toy Champion*)

SUPPORT THE RIVERVIEW THEATER THIS CHRISTMAS: Once again the Riverview Theater will collect food and monetary donations for the Food Shelf in the week or so before Christmas. So when you go to see “A Christmas Story” or “It’s a Wonderful Life” or “White Christmas,” bring a non-perishable food item. Volunteers from the Food Shelf will greet you and take your food donations to the Food Shelf pantry. (Judy Durfey, *Food Shelf*)



UMW Bazaar

CHRISTMAS PAGEANT ON DEC. 17 @ 4:00 PM: Mark your calendars for the annual Christmas Pageant on December 17, at 4:00 p.m. And be sure to invite family and friends and neighbors for this one-of-a-kind performance featuring the children and youth of Minnehaha UMC, a chance to sing your favorite Christmas songs and a seasonal message. Plus camels! (Jenia Strom, *Children’s Ministries*)

MAKE TIME FOR THE WINTER RETREAT JAN. 26–28: Every year the people of Minnehaha UMC travel to Lake Koronis Assembly Grounds in Paynesville, MN, for a winter retreat. We gather together for fellowship, relaxation, learning and worship. (And broomball.) The theme this year is: Fill My Cup. Watch for sign-up information. (Jenia Strom, *Children’s Ministries*)

ADVENT PARTY ON SAT., DEC. 2 @ 9:30 – 11:30 AM: Everyone is invited to prepare the church for the joyous season of Advent. We’ll sing carols, set up Christmas trees, bake cookies, decorate the Narthex and more. All ages are welcome! It’s Saturday morning,

December 2 from 9:30 to 11:30 AM. (Jenia Strom, *Children’s Ministries*)

RECORD-SETTING ATTENDANCE AT THURSDAY MORNING PLAYGROUP: On Thursday, November 9, the Minnehaha Playgroup had 24 adults and more than 40 kids at the church. Thank you, Tanya Ketcham, for this amazing mission serving families in our neighborhood! (Jenia Strom, *Children’s Ministries*)



Halloween party

TAIZE “BLUE CHRISTMAS” SERVICE ON DEC. 8 @ 7:00 PM: Taizé worship is our once-a-month service of music and meditation—using music with “simple” melody lines and periods of silence to quiet the soul and renew the spirit. On December 8, as we head into Christmas, we’ll have a special “Blue Christmas” service to try to bring strength and peace to those who are stressed or challenged by the season. (Char Johnson, *Taizé Worship Co-Coordinator*)



Baptism of Maxwell Knopke

NEXT MEETING IS DECEMBER 12: The next Church Council meeting will be December 12 at 6:30 p.m. Everyone in the church is invited to attend. Complete minutes of the meeting are available on request. (Dean Ammerman, Church Council)

—submitted by Dean Ammerman, Church Council Chair

Registration

Name(s) and age(s) of those attending:

Address:

Phone Number:

Email:

Dietary Restrictions:

Carpools will be arranged.

☐ I am able and willing to drive, I have room for _____

☐ I need a ride to the retreat.

Pricing information is listed on the backside of this form. Please complete it and submit to the office.

Alternately, you can register online at:
<https://form.jotform.com/Minnehaha/minnehaha-winter-retreat-2018>

What will we do there?

- Broomball

Bonfire

Basketball

Volleyball

Napping

Reading

Long walks in the woods

Movies

Cards

Board Games

Jigsaw Puzzles

Skit Night

Ping Pong

Air Hockey

Ice Skating

Cross-country Sking

Snow shoeing

Programming for adults, youth, & children

Worship on Sunday morning

No cooking; no washing dishes, no housework. Personal hygiene is optional.

Still have questions?

Talk to Joe Schlosser, Jenia Strom, Leilani Thompson, Paul Minehart, or Becky Sechrist.

We look forward to seeing you there!

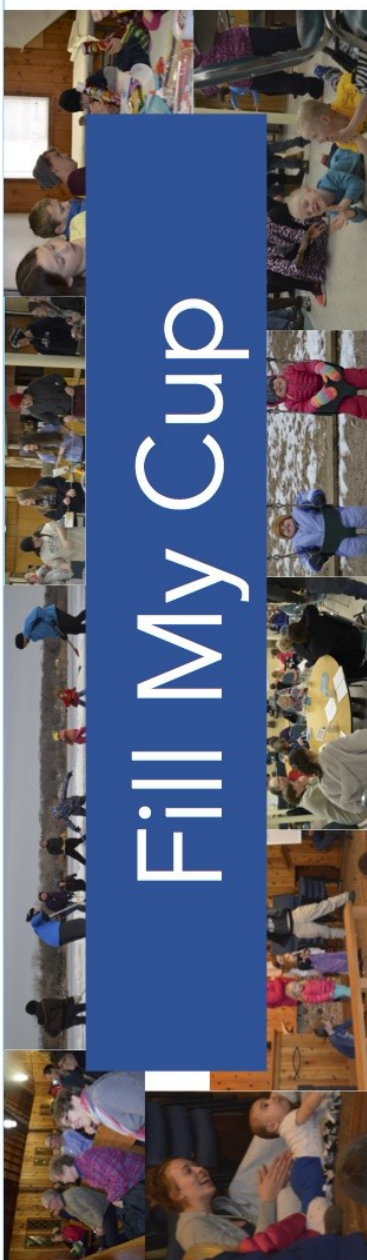
Join us
for ...



Minnehaha's
Winter Retreat



Jan. 26th-28th, 2018
at Lake Koronis
Assembly Grounds



2018 Winter Retreat Pricing

1 Adult Lakeview	\$125
2 Adults Lakeview	\$250
1 Adult Sunrise	\$190
2 Adults Sunrise	\$300
Youth (11-18)	\$95
Children (4-11)	\$80
Infant/Toddler (0-3)	Free

Lakeview: Twin beds, shared bathroom down the hall.

Sunrise: Two full sized beds, private bathroom in the room.

Please look to the left to see what your registration pays for. No refunds for people who leave early and/or eat less than 5 meals. The amount paid by partial attendees not used to cover the cost of this weekend will go into the camp scholarship fund.

Families in need are encouraged to ask for a scholarship (please speak with Jenia Strom, Joe Schlosser or Jason Emrick). If you would be willing to contribute to help others attend winter retreat, please indicate that amount below.

Total Amount Due: _____
Total Amount Paid: _____



Return registration form and check by January 15th to
Minnehaha United Methodist

3701 East 50th Street
 Minneapolis, MN 55417
 Phone: 612/721-6231
www.minnehaha.org

weekend, we leave our busy schedules behind and gather together for fellowship, for relaxation, and for learning and worship.

Your registration fee gives you:

- 2 nights lodging
- 5 meals (breakfast, lunch, and dinner on Saturday, and breakfast and lunch on Sunday)
- 3 hours of childcare
- 24/7 intergenerational opportunities
- Lots of playmates for everyone!

Does life seem a little overwhelming sometimes? Do you feel like you are constantly running on empty? Come join our great community for a fun, relaxing winter weekend away, and explore different ways to "fill your cup!" There will be structured time

for discussion and exploring new ideas, as well as free time for you to do activities YOU find most fulfilling. What better way to spend the weekend?! Come back restored-- full of energy and renewed purpose for sharing your gifts with the world.

Each year, people from Minnehaha UMC travel north to Lake Koronis Assembly Grounds in Paynesville, MN. For the

PREPARE FOR THE JOURNEY DECORATE THE CHURCH FOR ADVENT

Saturday, December 2 • 9:30 – 11:30 a.m.



Christmas tree pilgrimage!



Christmas carols!



**Doughnuts, coffee, and
hot cocoa!**

Join us on Saturday morning, December 2, from 9:30 to 11:30 a.m. to prepare the church for the joyous season of Advent.



It's a great time to get together and celebrate! We'll sing carols, set up Christmas trees, decorate the Narthex, and more!



Everyone is invited to deck the halls of Minnehaha and prepare the church for Advent.



Color murals in the Narthex!



Cookie Bake & Exchange – Bring dough! We'll bake cookies, and then exchange cookies at Noon and reserve some for shut-ins



**Decorate the
Sanctuary, Narthex, and
Fellowship Hall**



The Sounds of the Season

The sounds of the season as we anticipate Christmas are myriad. There are all the Christmas songs blaring out of speakers in stores, on sidewalks, and from radio stations. There is the hush that accompanies a heavy snowfall, accompanied by the sounds of horns and tires slipping on the streets. The ever-present sound of the bells being rung for Salvation Army kettles, and the commercials imploring you to buy this or that for your loved ones. Christmas television specials air over and over, and Christmas movies make return appearances. But my season has had a new sound to it this year.

Ever since the end of October, I have heard the sound of two great horned owls calling back and forth to each other from the trees in my neighborhood. The first time I heard it, they were obviously flying from backyard to backyard as I heard their calls move down the block. Other times they have remained stationary, simply hooting to one another as I walk by with the dogs in the late evening. Once I was even able to hear them through the closed windows of my quiet house in the middle of the night.

Their hooting is so soft sometimes, it's hard to hear them above the din of the noises around me. I live near an elevated street, and so the sound from passing cars carries in the night air. It's also a common route for emergency vehicles, sirens in full use. I find myself straining my ears to catch their call coming from the quiet wooded lot while trying to close my ears to all the other sounds around me. It's a good spiritual muscle to develop, this desire to listen intently. Just like it's hard to hear the owls sometimes, I find it's sometimes hard to hear God as well amidst the renditions of *Grandma Got Run Over By a Reindeer* and the closing of car doors and the people talking loudly on their cell phones. I have to practice listening carefully, because sometimes God is in the midst of those sounds, and sometimes God is over there, in that tree, calling out and waiting for me to answer back.

All of this started because I decided to try to incorporate the spiritual practice of evening prayer. It's too easy to get distracted by electronic things if I just sit in my house, so I've been trying to head outside. I leash up the dogs and go out into the night, letting the darkness surround me and letting my heart and mind turn to prayer as I walk around a block or two in the neighborhood. As the nights have gotten colder, I have to admit that I've been thinking of trading that practice in for the winter. When I get home from church, it's hard to put on walking clothes and then go back out into the cold to pray. But then the owls started calling. They've been calling for 3 weeks now, and they beckon me back outside. They remind me to listen not only to them, but to God and to the whole world around me. They have become my new call to prayer – and I am grateful for their help.

In joy,
Becky





3701 East 50th Street
Minneapolis, MN 55417

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E-Mail: becky@minnehaha.org
office@minnehaha.org
12/17



A Four-Legged Christmas Story

The Minnehaha UMC
Christmas Pageant

Sunday, 17th Dec. at 4pm
in the Sanctuary

Dinner Follows

www.minnehaha.org

